

DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS
Veterans Health Administration
Title 38, U.S.C. §7431, Physician, Dentist, Podiatrist and
Optometrist Annual Pay Ranges
Effective January 11, 2026

PAY TABLE 1 – CLINICAL SPECIALITY

	MINIMUM	MAXIMUM	COVERAGE
TIER 1	\$124,308	\$315,000	Staff Physician, Dentist, or Podiatrist
TIER 2	\$145,000	\$335,000	Supervisor, Program Manager, Section Chief
TIER 3	\$165,000	\$350,000	Service Chief, Service Line Manager, or other assignment whose scope and complexity is determined to exceed the definition of Tier 2; Network Level Assignment; National Program Responsibilities

COVERED CLINICAL SPECIALITIES

Allergy and Immunology
Endocrinology
Endodontics
Family Medicine
General Practice – Dentistry
Geneticist
Geriatrics
Hospital Epidemiology
Hospitalist
Infectious Diseases
Internal Medicine
Neurology

Optometry
Palliative Care
Periodontics
PM&R / SCI
Podiatry (General)
Preventive Medicine
Primary Care
Prosthodontics
Psychiatry
Rheumatology
Urgent Care
All other specialties or assignments

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PAY TABLE 2 – CLINICAL SPECIALTY

	MINIMUM	MAXIMUM	COVERAGE
TIER 1	\$124,308	\$400,000	Staff Physician, Dentist, or Podiatrist
TIER 2	\$200,000	\$400,000	Supervisor, Program Manager, Section Chief
TIER 3	\$225,000	\$400,000	Service Chief, Service Line Manager, or other assignment whose scope and complexity is determined to exceed the definition of Tier 2; Network Level Assignment; National Program Responsibilities

Anesthesiology
Cardiology
Critical Care
Dermatology and Dermatology MOHS
Emergency Medicine
Gastroenterology
Gynecology
Health Informatics
Hematology – Oncology
Nephrology
Nuclear Medicine
Ophthalmology
Oral Surgery
Otolaryngology

Pain Management
Pathology – Clinical, Anatomic
Podiatry (Surgery- Forefoot,
Rearfoot/Ankle, Advanced
Rearfoot/Ankle)
Pulmonary
Radiology – Diagnostic, Interventional
Radiation Oncology
Sleep Medicine
Surgery – Cardio-Thoracic, General,
Hand, Neurosurgery, Orthopedic, Plastic,
Thoracic, Transplant, Vascular
Urology

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PAY TABLE 3- CHIEF OF STAFF AND NETWORK CHIEF MEDICAL OFFICERS

	MINIMUM	MAXIMUM	COVERAGE
TIER 1	\$220,000	\$400,000	Network Chief Medical Officer
TIER 2	\$200,000	\$400,000	Chief of Staff
TIER 3	\$180,000	\$375,000	Deputy Chief Medical Officer, Deputy Chief of Staff

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PAY TABLE 4 – EXECUTIVE ASSIGNMENTS

	MINIMUM	MAXIMUM	COVERAGE
TIER 1	\$145,000	\$310,000	Deputy Under Secretary for Health; Assistant Under Secretaries for Health; Associate Deputy Under Secretary for Health; Assistant Deputy Under Secretary for Health; Chief Officers (VHA CO); Network Directors; Medical Center Directors
TIER 2	\$145,000	\$295,000	Executive Directors (VHA CO); Deputy to the Assistant Under Secretaries for Health; Chief Consultants (VHA CO); Deputy Chief Officers (VHA CO);
TIER 3	\$145,000	\$285,000	Deputy Chief Consultants (VHA CO); Deputy to the Executive Directors (VHA CO); VHA CO physicians, dentists, or podiatrists (non-SES equivalents) with an administrative/ executive role for more than 50%* of their FTE

**VHA CO providers providing direct patient care services more than 50% of their FTE should be assigned to tier 3 of the respective clinical pay table*